RIAAN GOVEN

Head of Digital Product | Financial Services

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1 Profile

An energetic leader with hands-on experience in identifying business opportunities and developing world class customer experience and digital marketing strategies. Leveraging an engaging leadership style bolstered by a dynamic mindset and talent for delivering creative, product management, advertising and data services.

A seasoned digital marketer with 9+ years of experience spanning the financial, telecommunication, automotive, FMCG, hospitality and retail industries. Expert at devising and rolling out strategies focused on paid, owned, and earned digital channels.

2 Work Experience

Feb 2022 – Current: 42th Rand Bank
Head of Web Production
Responsible for providing the strategic direction and leadership of a specialist web product team, by creating online products/features enabling the broader business strategy and delivering the best client experience for the biggest digital bank in South Africa.

USER EXPERIENCE

Responsible for the user-experience research, strategy development, wireframing, IA and user-testing for various website projects and mobile application (PWA) for financial services (Ubuntu Bank) and FinTechs (PayBridge). The focus has been content consumption on websites as well as functional behaviour changes.

Tools used:

- Miro
- InVision
- Figma / Zero Height

DEVELOPMENT

I have gained independent IT experience at work, where I have built webpages, components, widgets and templates via the Content Management System (Episerver/WordPress), JavaScript code implementation via Google Tag Manager as well as SEO meta tag implementation.

Tools & languages used:

- Episerver/WordPress (CMS & Plugins)
- Search Console
- Google Analytics and Tag Manager
- HTML/CSS
- Python

Feb 2017 – Jul 2021Ubuntu BankDigital Communication Manager Led and directed all digital marketing communications and channel management for one of the strongest banking brands in the world and largest active digital bank in South Africa. As the most senior digital marketing subject matter expert within the business, I advise the business on digital marketing best practices as well as digital product management based on data and consumer insights. During my tenure I have improved all aspects of digital marketing and social media (e.g., increasing Facebook following by 500%+ and operationalising social media for

Education
Jan 2024 – Current
Masters in Digital BusinessJohannesburg Business School
Dec 2023 – Current
The Ultimate Fullstack Web Development BootcampeLearn Academy (Online)
Dec 2023 – Current
Foundations of User Experience (UX) DesignTechLearn (Online)
Jan 2012 – Dec 2012
Honours Degree in Brand LeadershipBrandSchool Institute of Brand Leadership
Jan 2007 – Dec 2010
Bachelors Degree in Communication ScienceNational Distance Learning University

Certifications

- Fundamentals of Digital Marketing
- Digital Product Management
- Product Management

Professional Skills Strategy95 Data Analysis95 Digital Marketing95 Product Management85 Project Management80 Account Management100

product development and service delivery), evolved social media technology, and successfully developed an integrated digital ecosystem that derives business value from users.

Key Responsibilities

- Develop customer-centric roadmaps resulting in optimised client experience and lead generation through platform transformation.
- Responsible for generating sales opportunities through paid, owned, and earned digital marketing channels.
- Manage campaign activities across all digital channels (i.e., website, social media, digital advertising) focusing on brand awareness, encouraging positive online brand sentiment and client acquisition or retention.
- Generate brand awareness utilising online tactics and activities such as Digital PR and SEO.
- Management of performance marketing activities for the brand focusing on efficiencies and media attribution.

Highlights

- SocialPulse SA Banking Customer Sentiment Index 2016–2018.
- Created digital ecosystems that have increased website traffic and generated new leads by redesigning the corporate website and blog.
- Digital transformation by means of redesigns, evolving CRM and CMS systems and platform integration.
- Improved brand value, demand, and sales through effective campaign activities across all digital channels, including website, social media, and digital advertising.
- Developed customer-centric initiatives and campaigns to improve brand reputation and build a huge social media following.
- Won numerous brand and advertising awards.

Aug 2021 – Jan 2022PayBridge (Pty) LtdHead of Digital Direct and oversee all digital marketing (paid, owned and earned), internal communication and marketing management activities for one of the fastest scaling FinTechs in South Africa.

Nov 2016 – Feb 2017BlueOcean Media / AdWaveDigital Lead – GoldenBrew Group Directed digital marketing operations, including strategy development, digital media investment, implementation and reporting for GoldenLager, Sunbrau, Amberhof, Veldwind, and Crispbow. Researched and developed expert level understanding of market conditions, customer behaviours and trends to recommend tactical digital activations.

Key Responsibilities

- Leveraged strong analytical skills and solid industry exposure to devise digital media strategies and campaigns.
- Optimised decision-making process by interpreting relevant research using media tools available and compiling insight reports.
- Maximised operational efficiency and ensured timely completion of tasks by coordinating the development of effective media schedules.

Feb 2016 – Nov 2016MediaWorxSenior Digital Media Strategist – Protea Bank Served as senior digital media strategist working on the Protea Bank account. Oversaw digital media investment, strategy development, implementation, and reporting.

Jun 2015 – Feb 2016Beacon DigitalDigital Media Strategist / Digital Lead – SweetCo As a digital media strategist, I was responsible for the SweetCo Group's (CocoLoco, ZingBar, Mintella, Chewberry, Frostino, Breeze & Dentino) digital media investment, strategy development, implementation and reporting.

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